

⚠ HELD — DO NOT SUBMIT ⚠

Prepared for Helen Newton's review and sign-off. No submission has been made.
No mail service has been triggered. No electronic filing has been lodged.
In line with Helen's standing rule that official filings are prepared and reviewed rather than sent.

Västra Götaland University Hospital

Delivery Ward (Förlossningen) — Water Birth Protocol Development Working Group

Addressee Department Head, Delivery Ward and Obstetrics
From Helen Newton, Registered Midwife (barnmorska), Delivery Ward
On behalf of Water Birth Protocol Development Working Group
Reference VGR-DEL-WB-2026-R2 — Approval Submission
Meeting November 27, 2026 — department-head final approval
Salutation *(per Helen's preferred convention for this addressee, to be confirmed at sign-off)*

Subject

Submission of VGR-DEL-WB-2026-R2 for departmental approval, with staged staff rollout January 12, 2027 through March 30, 2027 and formal go-live on April 6, 2027.

Body

On behalf of the water birth protocol working group, I am submitting the revised water birth protocol (VGR-DEL-WB-2026-R2) for your approval at our meeting on November 27, 2026. The revision changes two clinical parameters against the current protocol (VGR-DEL-WB-2023-R1). Everything else is unchanged.

The two changes are a narrowing of the second-stage water temperature range from 36.5 to 38.0 °C down to 36.8 to 37.5 °C, and a clarification of the primiparous second-stage escalation threshold at 90 minutes. Both are supported by moderate to high strength evidence from studies indexed in the working group evidence log. A documentation reference for pool hygiene cadence is also updated to the 2025 European infection control consensus. This is not a clinical change.

The full submission dossier is provided as a set of coherent documents covering the evidence synthesis, the protocol draft with a parameter change log, the training rollout plan across three cohorts running January 12, 2027 through March 30, 2027, the costed rollout in a machine-readable form with a conservative and a stretched scenario, the equipment readiness picture

reconciled across the service desk and the department board, a risk register that includes the outcomes the working group holds open on insufficient evidence, and an evidence reconciliation log naming every source we trusted and every source we set aside.

The working group has been deliberately conservative on the long-horizon neonatal infection domain beyond 28 days. The evidence is thin and the revision does not claim a benefit or an absence of risk. That gap is carried in the risk register as a monitored item for the next review cycle rather than as a claim in the protocol text.

The equipment picture has one conditional dependency. Pool B seal replacement is complete and awaiting biomed sign-off scheduled for November 24, 2026. If that sign-off slips, the training rollout contingency documented in the training rollout plan applies for the first cohort.

The working group requests your approval to proceed with the staged rollout on the timeline set out above. Dr. Henrik Olsson and the senior midwives group have received a pre-meeting briefing and are prepared to raise any questions at the meeting rather than in advance.

Attachments referenced in the dossier

- `submission_dossier/00_cover_executive_summary.md`
- `submission_dossier/01_evidence_synthesis.md`
- `submission_dossier/02_protocol_draft.md`
- `submission_dossier/03_training_rollout_plan.md`
- `submission_dossier/04_training_costing.csv`
- `submission_dossier/05_equipment_readiness.md`
- `submission_dossier/06_risk_register.csv`
- `submission_dossier/07_evidence_reconciliation_log.csv`

Helen Newton

Registered Midwife (barnmorska), Delivery Ward

Västra Götaland University Hospital

On behalf of the Water Birth Protocol Development Working Group

Working group members: Helen Newton (lead), Malin Eriksson (team lead), Frida Holm (equipment lead), Dr. Henrik Olsson (obstetrics advisor).

**⚠ END OF HELD DRAFT — NOT SUBMITTED — AWAITING HELEN
NEWTON SIGN-OFF ⚠**